



Steamship

Steamships burned coal or oil to heat water and create steam to power an engine. This either drove a paddle wheel or turned a screw propeller, as found on the *SS Great Britain*. When launched in 1843, *SS Great Britain* was the largest ship in the world, and the first iron-hulled steamship powered by a screw propeller. Two years later, it became the first propeller-powered steamship to cross the Atlantic Ocean, a journey that took 14 days.

Hull › The 322-ft- (98-m-) long hull is fashioned out of overlapping iron plates riveted together to form a watertight outer body.

Main mast › The tallest mast on a ship. On the *SS Great Britain*, this is the only mast to carry large, square sails.

Bowsprit

SS Great Britain

Funnel

Decks › The *SS Great Britain* has three decks. The bottom one is used for cargo, supplies, and accommodation.

Steerage › Second-class accommodation, known as steerage, is at the bottom of the ship.